

Security+ 4.5 · Endpoint Security

Master CyberSec — Official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) Comprehensive Study Guide · **Lesson 4.5** —
Endpoint Security (9:25) · [Official YouTube Video ↗](#) · [Professor Messer Study Hub ↗](#)

Executive Lesson Summary: Endpoint security includes EDR (behavior monitoring + isolate + revert — evolution of antivirus), posture assessment (checks device before granting access — MDM, AV, patch), remediation, and NAC (802.1X + posture).

High-Yield Core Concepts Tested on Exam

- EDR: monitors behavior and responds (isolates host)
- Posture assessment: 'health check' before connecting to network
- NAC uses 802.1X and posture assessment
- EDR can revert malicious changes
- Remediation is part of endpoint security

Exam Tips & Classic Scenarios

- 'detects malicious behavior on endpoint and can isolate' = EDR

Typical Exam Scenario: An endpoint detects anomalous behavior and isolates the machine. This is an example of EDR.

Beyond the Video: Official CompTIA Exam Concepts, Protocols & Traps (Lesson 4.5 — Endpoint Security)

Why is this advanced coverage required for SY0-701? Video overviews provide foundational familiarity, but CompTIA tests practical engineering judgment and requires deep familiarity with the following protocols, acronyms, and operational nuances in this domain:

- **DLP:** Data Loss Prevention: Software/hardware safeguards monitoring, identifying, and preventing unauthorized exfiltration of sensitive organizational assets in use, transit, or rest.
- **EDR:** Endpoint Detection and Response: Agent installed on endpoints providing behavioral telemetry, threat detection, investigation capabilities, and live remote isolation.

Classic CompTIA Traps & Question Framing:

- Avoid rote memorization: CompTIA exam prompts regularly adjust technical constraints requiring you to defend why one valid security control is the *MOST appropriate* or *FIRST step*.
- Scrutinize question qualifiers: 'without additional licensing costs' favors native OS tools; 'granular administrative command accounting' favors TACACS+ over RADIUS; 'non-repudiation' mandates asymmetric private key signing.

Practice Questions with In-Depth Solutions (10 Questions)

Detailed answer key with step-by-step technical rationale and comprehensive distractor breakdown provided below. Attempt answering independently first.

1. The evolution of antivirus that monitors and RESPONDS to threats directly on the device is:

- A)** EDR
- B)** DLP
- C)** Network IDS
- D)** Proxy

2. Corporate scenario (Endpoint Security): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.5), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'EDR: sees behavior and RESPONDS (isolates the host)'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Implement the corresponding solution: EDR: sees behavior and RESPONDS (isolates the host)...
- B)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

3. Corporate scenario (Endpoint Security): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.5), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'Posture assessment: the 'health check' before connecting to the network'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Implement the corresponding solution: Posture assessment: the 'health check' before connecting to the network...
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

4. Corporate scenario (Endpoint Security): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.5), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'detects malicious behavior on endpoint and can isolate'=EDR'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'detects malicious behavior on endpoint and can isolate'=EDR...
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

5. Corporate scenario (Endpoint Security): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.5), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'endpoint detected anomalous behavior and isolated the machine'=EDR.' What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'endpoint detected anomalous behavior and isolated the machine'=EDR....
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

6. Corporate scenario (Endpoint Security): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.5), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'EDR: sees behavior and RESPONDS (isolates the host).' What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Implement the corresponding solution: EDR: sees behavior and RESPONDS (isolates the host)...
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

7. Corporate scenario (Endpoint Security): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.5), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'Posture assessment: the "health check" before connecting to the network'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials
- D)** Implement the corresponding solution: Posture assessment: the 'health check' before connecting to the network...

8. Corporate scenario (Endpoint Security): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.5), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'detects malicious behavior on endpoint and can isolate' = EDR. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'detects malicious behavior on endpoint and can isolate' = EDR
- B)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- C)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials

9. Corporate scenario (Endpoint Security): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.5), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'endpoint detected anomalous behavior and isolated the machine' = EDR.'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials
- D)** Implement the corresponding solution: 'endpoint detected anomalous behavior and isolated the machine' = EDR....

10. Corporate scenario (Endpoint Security): During a security review and compliance audit aligned with the CompTIA Security+ exam (SY0-701, Section 4.5), an analyst evaluates the following technical requirement: 'EDR: sees behavior and RESPONDS (isolates the host)'. What is the best recommendation or applicable control classification?

- A)** Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput
- B)** Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence
- C)** Implement the corresponding solution: EDR: sees behavior and RESPONDS (isolates the host)...
- D)** Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials

COMPREHENSIVE ANSWER KEY & DISTRACTOR BREAKDOWN

1) A — EDR.

✓ **Why it's correct:** EDR (Endpoint Detection and Response) is the evolution of traditional antivirus, combining continuous monitoring, behavioral detection, and direct response capabilities on the endpoint. In CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701), EDR is described as a solution that not only detects threats but also enables actions such as isolating the device, terminating malicious processes, and reverting changes. The question describes exactly an evolution of antivirus that monitors and responds to threats directly on the device, which corresponds to EDR.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *DLP*: DLP (Data Loss Prevention) is a technology focused on preventing the exfiltration of sensitive data by monitoring and blocking unauthorized transfers. It is not an evolution of antivirus and its primary function is not to detect and respond to malware on the endpoint. Therefore, it does not apply to the description.
- *Network IDS*: Network IDS (Network Intrusion Detection System) monitors network traffic for malicious activities, generating alerts. It does not act directly on the device to respond to threats, nor is it an evolution of antivirus. Its function is passive and focused on the network, not the endpoint. Thus, it is not the correct answer.
- *Proxy*: A proxy is an intermediary server that acts between users and the internet, capable of filtering content and caching pages. It is not an endpoint security solution with threat detection and response capabilities. Therefore, it does not correspond to the question.

2) A — Implement the corresponding solution: EDR: sees behavior and RESPONDS (isolates the host)....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.5 (Endpoint Security): EDR: sees behavior and RESPONDS (isolates the host).

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput*: Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence*: Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user behavior, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials*: Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

3) C — Implement the corresponding solution: Posture assessment: the 'health check' before connecting to the network....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.5 (Endpoint Security): Posture assessment: the 'health check' before connecting to the network. Posture assessment evaluates an endpoint's security state (e.g., patch level, antivirus status, configuration) before granting network access, ensuring that only compliant devices can connect.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput*: This directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents

and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).

- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* This destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. It makes it impossible to prove who made critical changes or executed malicious commands.

4) B — Implement the corresponding solution: 'detects malicious behavior on endpoint and can isolate'=EDR....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.5 (Endpoint Security): 'detects malicious behavior on endpoint and can isolate'=EDR. Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) solutions continuously monitor endpoint activities, detect malicious behavior using advanced analytics, and can automatically isolate compromised endpoints to prevent lateral movement and contain threats.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and violates compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

5) B — Implement the corresponding solution: 'endpoint detected anomalous behavior and isolated the machine'=EDR.....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.5 (Endpoint Security): 'endpoint detected anomalous behavior and isolated the machine'=EDR. Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) solutions continuously monitor endpoint activities, detect suspicious behavior, and can automatically isolate compromised endpoints to contain threats.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detect incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who made critical changes or malicious commands.

6) C — Implement the corresponding solution: EDR: sees behavior and RESPONDS (isolates the host)....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.5 (Endpoint Security): EDR (Endpoint Detection and Response) continuously monitors endpoint behavior, detects malicious activity, and can automatically respond by isolating the host,

killing processes, or quarantining files. This goes beyond traditional antivirus.

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to incident detection and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user conduct and do not block automated attacks, injections, or runtime malware.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

7) D — Implement the corresponding solution: Posture assessment: the 'health check' before connecting to the network....

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.5 (Endpoint Security): Posture assessment: the 'health check' before connecting to the network. Posture assessment verifies that an endpoint meets security requirements (e.g., updated OS, antivirus, patches) before granting network access, typically enforced via NAC (Network Access Control).

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls, rely solely on user conduct, and do not block automated attacks, injections, or runtime malware.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

8) A — Implement the corresponding solution: 'detects malicious behavior on endpoint and can isolate' = EDR.

✓ **Why it is correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.5 (Endpoint Security): 'detects malicious behavior on endpoint and can isolate' = EDR. Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) solutions continuously monitor endpoint activities, detect malicious behavior, and can automatically isolate an endpoint to contain threats.

✗ Why the others are wrong:

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* This directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to detecting incidents and it breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user behavior and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators using generic credentials:* This destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. It makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

9) D — Implement the corresponding solution: 'endpoint detected anomalous behavior and isolated the machine' = EDR.....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.5 (Endpoint Security): 'endpoint detected anomalous behavior and isolated the machine' = EDR. Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) solutions continuously monitor endpoint activities, use behavioral analysis to detect anomalies, and can automatically isolate a compromised host to contain the threat. This aligns with the described scenario.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to incident detection and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user behavior and do not block automated attacks, injections, or runtime malware.
- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. Makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.

10) C — Implement the corresponding solution: EDR: sees behavior and RESPONDS (isolates the host)....

✓ **Why it's correct:** According to the official CompTIA Security+ (SY0-701) exam objectives for lesson 4.5 (Endpoint Security): EDR: sees behavior and RESPONDS (isolates the host). EDR goes beyond signature-based detection by continuously monitoring endpoint behavior and enabling automated response actions such as host isolation, process termination, and quarantine.

✗ **Why the others are wrong:**

- *Temporarily disable audit logs to accelerate system throughput:* Directly violates the Accounting pillar and forensic traceability. Without logs, the team is blind to incident detection and breaks compliance standards (PCI DSS, ISO 27001).
- *Replace preventive technical controls with informal terms of adherence:* Informal terms are administrative controls that rely solely on user conduct and do not block automated attacks, injections, or malware at runtime.
- *Allow shared access among administrators with generic credentials:* Destroys individual accountability and non-repudiation. It makes it impossible to prove who performed critical changes or malicious commands.